Dr Bedi said they had just come back from Mumbai and noted social activist Anna Hazare had agreed to fast outside the Maharashtra assembly for the cause of a Lok Pal. ‘You can interview Anna too,’ she suggested helpfully.

That’s when I offered a final piece of gratuitous advice, as editors are often prone to do. Tahrir Square had just happened in Egypt and the sight of thousands of citizens marching on Cairo’s streets had captured global eyeballs. ‘Let me be honest, Arvind and Kiranji. If you really want people to sit up and notice your Lok Pal campaign, you need to create your own Tahrir Square-like moment here in India. Only then will the system awaken! And if you want the national TV channels to focus on your cause, then bring Anna to Delhi. In Mumbai, it will remain a local story.’

Little did I know then that a casual conversation over a television programme would transform into a volcanic nationwide eruption over corruption just a few months later. Forget signature campaigns, this was about to become the biggest story of 2011.

If Anna Hazare became the face of the Lok Pal movement, Kejriwal became its heartbeat. He planned, organized and micromanaged the entire campaign, tirelessly working eighteen hours a day to ensure its success. ‘I am Anna’s Hanuman,’ is how he described himself. Once, sitting with Anna at Maharashtra Sadan, I asked him about his equation with Kejriwal. *‘Arre, main toh ek chote gaon ka fakir hoon, Arvind jaanta hai ki bade shahar mein kya karna chahiye’* (I am a fakir from a small village, Arvind knows what you need to do in the big city).

The IITian and the Gandhian; the tech-savvy mobilizer and the crowd-pulling ascetic; the urban activist and a rural folk hero—Kejriwal and Anna forged a unique partnership that, by August 2011, had the mighty Indian state bending before it. Ironically, a little over a year later, the duo had parted ways. Those who know Anna and Kejriwal were not surprised. Anna was a nomad with his roots in rural Maharashtra; he often moved from one agitation to another. He relished the national limelight for a while but eventually was more comfortable in his home environment in Ralegan